

Traditional clothing

The clothes worn in some parts of the world combine modern lifestyles and traditions thousands of years old. Traditional national costumes often reflect the dress of peasants, whose garments were suited to the local climate and the kind of work they performed.



Canada

Inuit people dress to protect themselves against cold weather: in northern Canada, it snows from October to May.

Tanzania

The Maasai wear vivid pieces of cloth called *rubeka*. Young women who are old enough to marry wear special headdresses.

South Korea

This traditional silk costume is called *hanbok*, meaning "Korean clothing". It is worn on special occasions.

Vietnam

The traditional outfit of the Dao people, a hill tribe, is a *lamchu*: a scarf, skirt, jacket, and *hang pen* wound around the legs.

India

The most popular dress for Indian women is the *sari*, which is usually made from a length of silk or cotton.



Elegantly draped sari

Tying a sari

The sari is a length of material, between 5 and 9 metres long, and just over a metre wide. It is worn over a tight-fitting bodice, called a *choli*, and a long petticoat. When the weather gets hot, the sari can be adjusted to let in cool air.



Choli

Sari fabric

1 First, the material is wrapped round once, and tucked into the petticoat.

2 The sari fabric is pleated, then tucked into the petticoat again.

3 The spare fabric is draped over the shoulder.



Coco Chanel

The French designer Gabrielle "Coco" Chanel (1883–1971) had a powerful influence on Parisian and world fashion for almost 60 years. Her designs stressed simplicity and comfort at a time when clothes tended to be restrictive and uncomfortable. Many of her innovations are now fashion classics, such as bell-bottomed trousers, bobbed hair, and the so-called "little black dress".

Body decoration

Every culture has practised some form of body decoration, ranging from scarring and tattooing, which are permanent, to make-up and body paint, which last for only a few hours. One of the oldest forms of body decoration is jewellery, worn to show wealth and status, for protection and healing, or for beauty. Examples include rings, necklaces, earrings, bracelets, and brooches.



Jewellery

Beads, berries, feathers, shells, bone, glass, precious stones, and metals have all been used to make jewellery. Most fashion jewellery is made from cheap materials, such as plastic, because it is only worn for a short time.

Body painting

People paint their faces and bodies to mark a religious occasion, celebrate important events in their community, or ward off illness. Sikh brides, for example, paint ornate, beautiful patterns on their hands using dye from the henna plant.



Body paint in Papua New Guinea

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Fashion

Following fashion (the changing trends in clothing) was once so expensive that only the wealthy could afford it. Today, however, advances in manufacturing, and the invention of synthetic fabrics, allow more people to follow fashion. Styles have changed faster than ever before, and fashion has become big business. Shows by fashion houses such as Dior (France) or Ralph Lauren (USA) attract buyers from all over the world.



High-fashion wedding dress

Hats and shoes

Through the ages, hats and shoes have come in many styles: hats have ranged from headdresses to berets, shoes from simple leather sandals to chunky platform boots.

Riding hat



Chin strap

Police officer's cap

Hats may stand for authority, as with the police officers' cap, which is part of their uniform.



Badge

Shoe

Shoes must suit people in different climates, as well as follow fashions. They are commonly made from durable leather, but rubber, plastic, silk, and canvas are also used.



Cross-section of shoe

Steel shank supports arch of foot